

Design Document – RMD Tracker

Northeastern Web Development Course Summer 2026

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Project Description: RMD Tracker is a full-stack web application designed to help financial advisors manage Required Minimum Distributions for their clients. Once a client reaches 73 years of age, the IRS requires a minimum annual withdrawal from their retirement accounts or they face a penalty. At small offices this process is often managed manually in shared spreadsheets, which can create inconsistencies, for example when multiple staff members track completion differently. RMD Tracker centralizes this workflow into a single dashboard where advisors and their staff can manage clients, track accounts across multiple custodians, calculate total RMD obligations, and monitor RMD fulfillment status across their entire book of business. Account distribution settings carry over year to year, so advisors only need to verify and update amounts rather than re-enter everything from scratch.

User Personas:

Sarah, the Financial Advisor

Sarah is an independent financial advisor who manages a book of over 100 clients, many of whom are in or approaching retirement. She needs a quick way to see which clients have RMD obligations for the current year and whether those obligations have been met. She doesn't have time to dig into the details of every account but wants confidence that nothing has fallen through the cracks before year end.

Mark, the Office Staff Member

Mark is a part-time staff member at a small financial services firm who is responsible for the day-to-day administrative work of tracking RMDs. He maintains client and account records, logs distributions as they come in, calls companies to acquire the calculated RMD amounts for each client, and updates auto distribution settings when clients make changes to their setup. He needs a reliable system that multiple people can use without creating the formatting inconsistencies that come with a shared spreadsheet.

User Stories:

- As Sarah, I want to view a dashboard of all clients with RMD obligations this year so that I can quickly see who has and hasn't met their minimum distribution.
- As Mark, I want to add, edit, and deactivate clients so that the client list stays accurate and up to date.
- As Mark, I want to add, edit, delete and manage accounts for each client including custodian, account type, and auto distribution setup so that all relevant account information is stored in one place.
- As Mark, I want to create and update RMD records for each account so that I can track the amount taken and whether the obligation has been met for the year.
- As Mark, I want auto distribution settings to carry over when a new RMD record is created for the next year so that I don't have to re-enter the same information annually.
- As Mark, I want to delete an account that was entered in error or has been closed so that the client's account list stays accurate

(Design Mockups on following pages)

Dashboard Page Design Mockup:

RMD Tracker

Nav Bar

RMD Tracker - Dashboard

How to Use

Add Client Button

Progress Summary Visual

Filter options (Year, Client name, Advisor, Status)

Full list of client names, total RMD obligations for selected year, total taken, and rmd status

Client Detail Page Design Mockup:

RMD Tracker

Nav Bar

<- Back to Dashboard

Edit Client Button

Delete Client Button

Client Info Card

Client Accounts

Full list of clients accounts
(Account info and individual RMD info/status)

Total RMD amount and amount taken sum values

Add Account Button

Account Detail Page Design Mockup:

The mockup shows a page layout for an account detail. At the top, there is a header bar with 'RMD Tracker' on the left and a 'Nav Bar' on the right. Below the header, there are three buttons: '<- Back to Client', 'Edit Account Button', and 'Delete Account Button'. Under these buttons are two info cards: 'Account info card' and 'Auto distribution settings info card'. Below the info cards is a section titled 'RMD Records' which contains a large box with the text 'Full list of RMD records for selected account (year, RMD amount, amount taken, status, edit/delet)'. At the bottom left, there is an 'Add RMD Record Button'.

RMD Tracker

Nav Bar

<- Back to Client

Edit Account Button

Delete Account Button

Account info card

Auto distribution settings info card

RMD Records

Full list of RMD records for selected account
(year, RMD amount, amount taken, status, edit/delet)

Add RMD Record Button

Accounts by Company Page Design Mockup:

RMD Tracker

Nav Bar

Accounts by Company

Filter by year, company, or status

Sort by company, client, status, auto distribution or account type

Full list of client accounts

(company, client name, account type, account #'s, Auto distribution setting, RMD amount, status)